

Strixhaven University
Office of Admissions
The Biblioplex, Central Campus



Dear Strixhaven Applicant,

We recognize and appreciate the time and effort you devoted to your application. Strixhaven University is home to the brightest minds and most ambitious scholars of magic, and our community is carefully curated to foster innovation, excellence, and the relentless pursuit of knowledge. It is with great pleasure that we extend to you an official offer of admission as a First-Year Student in the coming semester. Orientation will take place on **Sunday at 3pm** in the Hall of Oracles, where you will be formally welcomed and introduced to the foundations of your academic journey.

The next step now lies with you. Enclosed, you will find additional information about your studies and campus life. We encourage you to review these materials carefully as you consider whether to accept your place among Strixhaven's distinguished student body.

Your first year will be devoted to General Magical Studies, the essential foundation upon which all advanced magical disciplines are built. Through rigorous coursework and immersive research, you will gain the knowledge and skills necessary to prepare for the specialized path you will embark upon in the years to come.

As a First-Year Student, you will receive your official Strixhaven robes—or other appropriate outerwear suited to your magical specialty—on Orientation Day, held in the Hall of Oracles within the Biblioplex. Use this time wisely as you acclimate to life on campus. Engage with your peers, explore the vast resources of our libraries, and immerse yourself in the intellectual vibrancy and dynamic traditions that define Strixhaven.

To confirm your enrollment, we ask that you complete the Campus Enrollment Card and return it as soon as possible.

As stated during the application process, tuition for the upcoming academic year is 65,000 gold pieces (1,300 lbs / 590 kg of gold) or an equivalent payment arrangement previously agreed upon with your Admissions Officer. Please be advised that Strixhaven reserves the right to modify, reject, or revoke admission at any time and for any reason in accordance with university policy.

On behalf of the faculty, staff, and students of Strixhaven, I extend my personal congratulations on your acceptance. We look forward to welcoming you into our halls of learning and witnessing the extraordinary contributions you will bring to our university.

Sincerely,

Avys Orisim

Avys Orisim, Director of Admission

STRIXHAVEN
SCHOOL OF MAGES

The mission of Strixhaven University is to discover and preserve magical knowledge, to disseminate that knowledge from one generation to the next, to promote free and open study of magic in all its forms, and to enhance the lives of people throughout the world through the use of magic.

First Year Courses

You will select 3 courses of interest for your first year. You will be automatically enrolled in the required courses “Magical Physiologies” and “Basic Magical Auras” in addition to the courses you select.



Arcano-botany for Beginners

Witherbloom

A hands-on introduction to the magical properties of plants and fungi. Students will learn the basics of cultivating enchanted flora, brewing botanical elixirs, and harnessing plant-based magic for healing, defense, and alchemy.



Beginning Computational Magic

Quandrix

An exploration of the mathematical foundations of spellcasting, covering arcane equations, numerical pattern recognition, and the manipulation of magical algorithms. Students will gain insight into how numbers and magic intertwine to shape reality.



Beginning Inkomancy

Silverquill

A study of magical inks, enchanted script, and the power of the written word. Students will practice imbuing writing with arcane energy, creating spells through calligraphy, and binding magic into texts, scrolls, and sigils.



History of Magic and Art

Prismari

An examination of how artistic expression and magical innovation have shaped civilizations throughout time. Students will study historical spellcraft, enchanted artifacts, and the evolution of magic-infused artwork across cultures.



Introduction to Archaeomancy

Lorehold

A deep dive into the use of magic to uncover and interpret ancient relics, forgotten ruins, and lost histories. Students will practice magical excavation techniques, spirit-channeling for historical insight, and deciphering cryptic inscriptions.

Colleges of Strixhaven

As you consider your avenue of study at Strixhaven and beyond, you may find yourself drawn to one of the five colleges more so than the others. Each school embraces the paradoxical unity of two polar principles: life and death, order and chaos, reason and emotion, and so on. We have included a brief summary of each college, but personally experiencing each institution for yourself is the only true way to discover where you belong on campus. Like many of our students, you may find yourself drawn to interdisciplinary studies and heavily involved with multiple colleges.

Lorehold

College of Archaeomancy



Archaeomancy—a term that describes the exploration of ancient things through magic. Our mages explore the past by poring over archaeological sites, calling forth magical energy from old tomes, and summoning the spirits of long-dead historical figures. Lorehold mages travel far and wide across the world, gathering relics of bygone ages and learning dead languages to unpack the secrets of history.

Studies and Philosophy

Lorehold College is devoted to the study of history, broadly understood to include the various aspects of culture, behavior, and social relationships that shape historical events. Our studies include various subdivisions of history (military history, social history, cultural history), archaeology, anthropology, psychology, sociology, religion, and economics. Lorehold mages use magic to unearth secrets and share illumination.

Order and Chaos

Order versus Chaos encapsulates the fundamental conflict at the heart of Lorehold's philosophy. This conflict revolves around the forces that underlie and drive history.

*Is the course of time driving toward a well-ordered ideal state or slowly devolving into chaos?
Are deep patterns hidden in historical texts, or is time a series of coincidence and happenstance?*

The perspective of order emphasizes the structures that pull people together—law, religion, economics, education, social class, and so on—and how those structures drive historical events. Order focuses on systemic changes and the actions of people collectively.

The perspective of chaos, by contrast, emphasizes individual actions, personal bonds of families and friends, and the disruptive force of lone, passionate people in history. Scholars of chaos gravitate toward reckless discovery and the spirit of adventure in their research of the past—the essence and emotion of history over precision or procedure.

Prismari

College of Elemental Arts

Prismari, the College of Elemental Arts, is devoted to the study and practice of art intertwined with magic. Our mage-students wield magic in spectacles of creativity: masterpieces of showy, over-the-top magic. They use elemental magic to express who they are and how they see the world, often combining different types of energy—fire, water, air, earth, lightning, heat, cold—in powerful expressions of conflict and harmony.

Studies and Philosophy

Prismari College is dedicated to the arts. Our scholars view art as the fundamental form of self-expression and magic as a tool, a medium, and an inspiration. Prismari studies focus on visual arts (including architecture, painting, and sculpture) and performing arts (such as dance, music, and theater). Prismari mages use magic to weave the elements into their creations; they might juxtapose fire alongside paint, ceramics, or fabric, or they might choreograph elaborate works that unite a dancer's movements with gusts and eddies of air.

Perfection and Expression

The fundamental conflict of philosophy for Prismari mages is framed as perfection versus expression—or, sometimes, as intellect versus emotion.

What is the purpose of art? Is it to make people think things or make people feel things? Is it supposed to be carefully thought out or raw and spontaneous? Is mastery of art a matter of honing precise techniques to a point of perfection or of perfectly expressing a raw emotional state? Does art aspire to express universal truths or intensely personal ones?

The perspective of perfection focuses on technique, analysis, theory, aesthetics, and universal principles. It embraces intellect over emotion, strives to be thought-provoking and reflective, and aspires to mastery. Its mages tend to use elemental forces of cold, water, and wind.

The perspective of expression instead emphasizes the portrayal of personal emotional truths. Its mages value improvisation, innovation, and rule-breaking, and they often favor elemental magic using fire, lightning, and earth.



Quandrix

College of Numeromancy

Quandrix is the College of Numeromancy. Encompassing the study of patterns, fractals, and symmetries to wield power over the fundamental mathematics of nature. Quandrix mages can summon creatures made of fractals or turn abstract theories into towering, spiraling patterns. Through our love to expand and multiply, our mages can increase their knowledge or size by bending numbers. We dwell in the overlap between the theoretical and the natural—from the fabric of our robes to the nature of our spells, we make use of repeated elements, clever symmetries, and surprising geometry to express the complex truths we study.

Studies and Philosophy

The studies undertaken within Quandrix College include mathematics, physics, logic, statistics, metaphysics, and various fields of theoretical magic. Students from the other colleges often delve into Quandrix courses to bolster the theoretical underpinnings of their studies, and our studies of nature and Witherbloom's explorations of practical biology have significant overlap.

Substance and Theory

Is mathematics a natural force that exists in the universe independent of the constructs of intelligent minds, or is it a theoretical framework created by those who study it? Is the work of the scholar to discover what is or to define what could be?

The perspective of substance emphasizes physical reality. In this view, math is embodied in the natural forces of the multiverse, waiting to be discovered by those with the intellectual fortitude to delve into those secrets. Quandrix mages who embrace this view use magic to bring numerical concepts to life, creating or altering physical reality out of mathematical possibility.

The perspective of theory focuses on the abstract realms of conjecture and possibility. Its scholars view math as a lens through which a mind can understand the cosmos, not something that exists independently in the world. Mages who embrace this perspective use their spells to weave illusions and manipulate the fabric of magic itself.



Silverquill

College of Eloquence

Silverquill is the College of Eloquence, and our mages—stylish, intimidating, and driven—are masters of the magic of words. They create spells from spoken-word battle poetry or magical manifestations of the written word, scribing patterns of runic ink in the air.

Silverquill mages are natural leaders—fiercely competitive, razor-sharp in wit, and never content with second place.

Studies and Philosophy

The curriculum of Silverquill College revolves around words, encompassing literature (including fiction, essays, drama, and poetry), languages, linguistics, oratory, rhetoric, and dramatic performance. Students from other colleges often take Silverquill courses to improve their communication skills, learning to speak and write more effectively about their primary field of study.

Radiance and Shadow

The metaphor of radiance and shadow takes concrete form in Silverquill magic, as students learn to manifest brilliant light or inky darkness with their spells. The fundamental argument among Silverquill's scholars centers on the purpose of communication.

Is it to help others or further a personal agenda? Does literature selflessly better society or selfishly advance one's own goals?

The college's perspective of radiance envisions language as sunlight emanating from the speaker or writer to illuminate others and make the world a brighter place. Mages who embrace this view use their language skills—and their magic—to uplift and empower others, to shine light on the evils of society, and to inspire the best in those around them.

The college's perspective of shadow focuses on the power of language to stab, to expose stinging truths, and to obfuscate secrets. The magic of shadow mages often manifests as bolts or blades of darkness or blotches of flowing ink, and its effects range from a sting of shame to an assault on the target's life energy.



Witherbloom

College of Essence Studies

At Witherbloom, the College of Essence Studies, we draw power from the opposing forces of life and death. Here mages brew their spells from natural components and the essence of living creatures, using that power to heal or harm the living or to raise or entreat the dead. They can cause entire forests to blossom out of nowhere or call down old curses that scourge flesh from bone. Some Witherbloom mages defend ecosystems from pollution, while others revel in the power of corruption. They're at home riding zombie crocodiles down a languid river, picking herbs for a potion to treat a disease, brooding over a chorus of swamp frogs, or summoning fearsome avatars of nature.

Studies and Philosophy

The curriculum of Witherbloom College focuses on various sciences, revolving around the life sciences. Biology, ecology, botany, chemistry, and related sciences combine with the study and manipulation of the magical energy of the Positive Plane and the Negative Plane, the primal forces of life and death.

Growth and Decay

The two ideologies of Witherbloom are traditionally represented in the deans, called the Dean of the Root and the Dean of the Vein. These titles are a somewhat abstract way of framing the core division in the college's philosophy:

Is growth or decay the driving force in nature?

The philosophy of the Root (growth) focuses on life and its irrepressible drive to thrive. This view celebrates the diversity and adaptability of life-forms, from the tiniest cells to the most complex networks of living things. The growth philosophy asserts that the urge to survive and reproduce is the most essential principle in the cosmos. Mages who adopt this view wield positive energy and practice healing magic.

The philosophy of the Vein (decay) focuses on the inevitability of death and decay. The decay philosophy sees life energy as a resource to be consumed, rather than a good to be nourished for its own sake. Mages who adopt this view wield negative energy and practice necromancy.



